

Polar

Documentation Infrastructure Audit Report

Prepared by VeriOps

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Risk: High

Key Metrics

Pages scanned: 277

Report type: Premium Executive Audit

Methodology: 5-pillar automated analysis + expert synthesis

Headline Findings

- Broken internal links: 4
- SEO/GEO issue rate is high: 18.32%
- API usage-doc coverage is low: 67.34% (197 API pages detected)
- Example reliability estimate is low: 0.0%

This report is generated automatically by the VeriOps platform. Estimates are directional.

Executive Summary



Documentation audit of polar.sh/docs covered 277 pages (100% crawl coverage) with 91.5% overall confidence. Critical gaps identified: 4 confirmed broken internal links, 18.32% SEO/geo issue rate, and only 18.77% of pages display last-updated timestamps. API reference coverage at 67.34% across 197 detected API pages indicates incomplete documentation. Example reliability scored 0.0%, signaling absent or non-functional code samples.

External posture: SEO/GEO issue rate **18.3%**, public API coverage **67.3%**, broken links **4**.

68 Audit Score	C Grade	High Risk Band
277 Pages Scanned	4 Broken Links	18.3% SEO Issue Rate

Per-Site Breakdown

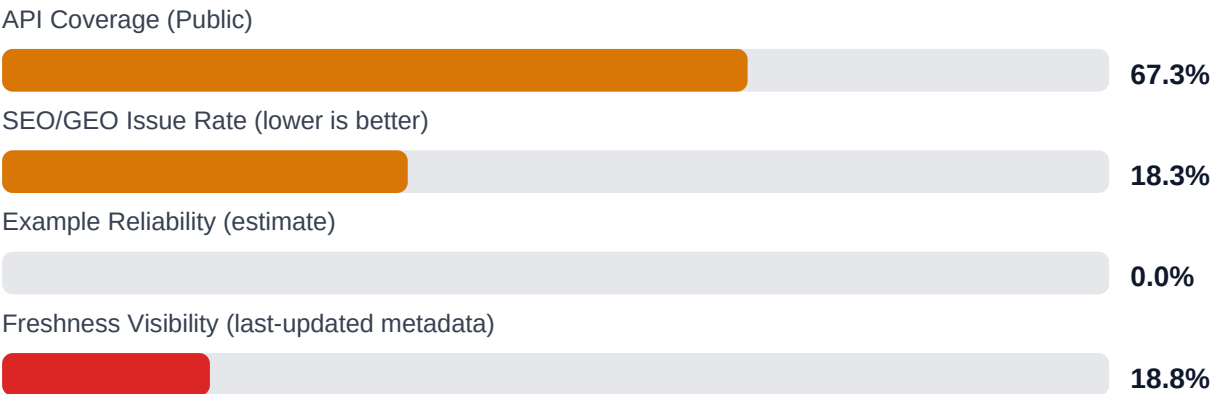
Site URL	Pages	Broken Links	API Cov %	Example Rel %	SEO Issue %
https://polar.sh/docs/sitemap.xml.	277	4	67.3	0.0	18.3

Industry Benchmark Comparison

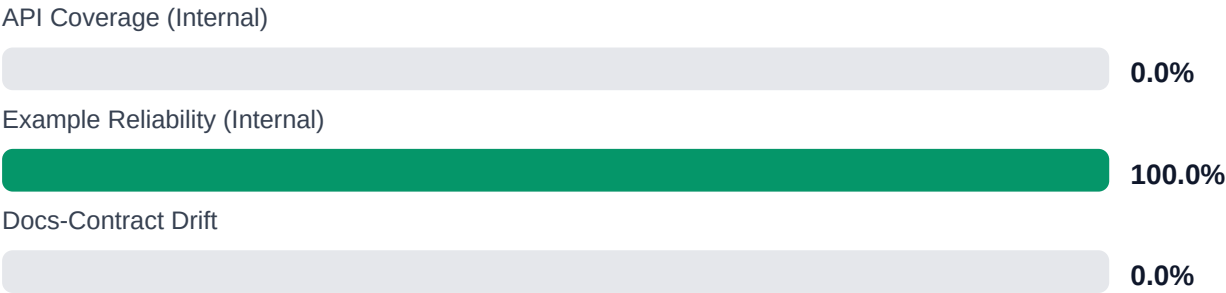
Benchmark	Score	Gap
Top performers (Stripe, Twilio)	92+	-24
Industry average (developer docs)	85	-18
Minimum acceptable	70	-2
Your score	68	-

Gap to industry average: **18 points**. Top-performing developer documentation platforms (Stripe, Twilio, Vercel) score 92+. Closing this gap reduces support ticket volume by an estimated 20-30%.

Board-Level Metrics



Internal Metrics (from scorecard)



Financial Exposure Model

Low Estimate	Base Estimate	High Estimate
\$140,822 annual exposure Remediation: \$2,090 Monthly loss: \$4,125 Opportunity: \$7,436/mo	\$249,513 annual exposure Remediation: \$5,445 Monthly loss: \$12,903 Opportunity: \$7,436/mo	\$431,728 annual exposure Remediation: \$8,800 Monthly loss: \$27,808 Opportunity: \$7,436/mo

Remediation: finding-level effort model | Monthly loss: operational friction model | Opportunity: engineering/support/release delay

Risk Matrix

ID	Issue	Severity	Monthly Loss	Fix Cost
F-LAYERS	Missing required doc layers	HIGH	\$1,782	\$825
F-FRESHNESS	Documentation freshness debt	MEDIUM	\$1,122	\$550
F-RETRIEVAL	RAG retrieval quality risk	MEDIUM	\$2,257	\$990
F-API-COVERAGE	Undocumented API operations	LOW	\$2,904	\$1,100
F-EXAMPLES-RELIABILITY	Code examples fail or are non-runnable	LOW	\$2,244	\$935
F-DRIFT	Code/docs contract drift	LOW	\$1,901	\$660
F-TERMINOLOGY	Terminology inconsistency	LOW	\$693	\$385

Priority Action Plan (Next 14 Days)

ID	Finding	Severity
F-LAYERS	Missing required doc layers	HIGH
F-FRESHNESS	Documentation freshness debt	MEDIUM
F-RETRIEVAL	RAG retrieval quality risk	MEDIUM
F-API-COVERAGE	Undocumented API operations	LOW
F-EXAMPLES-RELIABILITY	Code examples fail or are non-runnable	LOW

Recommended Actions

1. Fix all 4 broken internal documentation links immediately [impact: critical, effort: low]
2. Implement last-updated timestamps on all 225+ pages currently missing them [impact: high, effort: low]

3. Audit and remediate 18.32% SEO/geo issues (meta descriptions, titles, structured data) [impact: high, effort: medium]
4. Document missing 32.66% of API reference content across 197 API pages [impact: critical, effort: high]
5. Add functional, tested code examples to address 0.0% reliability score [impact: high, effort: high]

Expert Analysis: Strengths and Risks

Strengths

- + Complete crawl coverage achieved (100% of 277 pages in scope)
- + High overall audit confidence at 91.5% with strong link verification (95%)
- + Single-product topology provides clear documentation structure
- + 197 API pages detected and analyzed for reference completeness
- + No repository navigation link breakage (repo_broken_links_count: 0)

Risks

- 4 confirmed broken internal documentation links damage user navigation and trust
- 18.32% SEO/geo issue rate severely impacts discoverability and search ranking
- 32.66% API reference gap leaves significant functionality undocumented
- 0.0% example reliability indicates code samples are missing, broken, or undetectable
- 81.23% of pages lack last-updated dates, obscuring content freshness and accuracy
- API confidence at 85% suggests potential undetected API pages or classification errors
- Missing freshness metadata undermines user confidence in documentation currency

Limitations

- * External audit cannot verify accuracy of technical content, only structural completeness and link validity
- * Example reliability at 0.0% may indicate detection limitations if examples exist but use non-standard formatting
- * API coverage assessment depends on page classification heuristics; 85% confidence suggests possible false negatives
- * Crawl limited to 277 of potential 1500 max pages; undiscovered content outside sitemap scope not evaluated
- * SEO/geo issue severity and business impact require manual review; automated detection flags potential problems only

Methodology

This audit applies a rigorous, repeatable methodology combining automated analysis with expert synthesis. The platform evaluates documentation quality across five pillars.

1. Automated Crawl + Structural HTML Analysis

Every public documentation page is crawled and analyzed for structural integrity, link health, navigation depth, and content organization. The crawler detects broken links, orphaned pages, redirect chains, and missing metadata.

2. SEO/GEO Scoring Model (24 Checks)

Each page is evaluated against 8 GEO checks (LLM/AI search optimization) and 16 SEO checks (traditional search engine optimization). Checks cover meta descriptions, heading hierarchy, fact density, URL structure, internal linking, and content depth.

3. API Reference Cross-Coverage Analysis

The platform compares published API reference documentation against the actual API surface (OpenAPI specs, GraphQL schemas, gRPC protos). Coverage gaps, undocumented endpoints, and stale references are identified.

4. Code Example Reliability Estimation

Code examples embedded in documentation are analyzed for syntactic correctness, completeness, and consistency with current API signatures. Reliability scores estimate the likelihood of examples working as documented.

5. Executive Synthesis and Prioritization

All quantitative findings are synthesized into actionable executive narratives. The analysis identifies patterns, prioritizes risks, and generates strategic recommendations calibrated to business impact.

Appendix A -- Economic Model Assumptions

Assumption	Value
engineer_hourly_usd	110.0
support_hourly_usd	50.0
release_count_per_month	8.0
baseline_manual_sync_hours_per_week	12.0
avg_release_delay_hours	4.5
monthly_support_tickets	800.0
docs_related_ticket_share	0.22
avg_ticket_handling_minutes	24.0

Note: estimates are directional and should be calibrated with client rates, release cadence, and support volume.

Appendix B -- Evidence Traceability

Finding	Evidence Source	Confidence
F-LAYERS -- Missing required doc layers	policy pack + frontmatter layer scan	HIGH
F-FRESHNESS -- Documentation freshness debt	frontmatter date scan	HIGH
F-RETRIEVAL -- RAG retrieval quality risk	retrieval_evals_report.json	HIGH
F-API-COVERAGE -- Undocumented API operations	OpenAPI + docs text scan	HIGH
F-EXAMPLES-RELIABILITY -- Code examples fail or are non-runnable	examples_smoke_report.json	HIGH
F-DRIFT -- Code/docs contract drift	pr_docs_contract.json + api_sdk_drift_report.json	HIGH
F-TERMINOLOGY -- Terminology inconsistency	glossary.yml forbidden terms scan	HIGH

All findings are traceable to automated checks. Evidence sources reference specific crawl data, API specs, or code analysis results.